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✦ AI Overview



To capture and monitor **all network traffic across all interfaces** simultaneously on macOS, you must use Apple's special `pktdap` pseudo-interface. Unlike Linux, which uses `any`, macOS requires the `pktdap,all` argument. Linuxize +1

The Ultimate "Monitor All" Command

Run the following command in your Terminal:

```
bash
```

```
sudo tcpdump -i pktdap,all -nn -k NP
```

Use code with caution.



Breakdown of the Flags

- `sudo` : Required because capturing raw packet data requires root privileges on macOS. Apple Developer +1
- `-i pktdap,all` : Instructs `tcpdump` to use Apple's **Packet Tap** interface to capture traffic from every active network interface at the same time (Wi-Fi, Ethernet, Loopback, VPNs, etc.).
- `-nn` : Disables name and port resolution. This speeds up the process significantly and prevents your Mac from generating extra DNS traffic while trying to translate IP addresses into hostnames. Linuxize
- `-k NP` : An exclusive Apple-specific extension. It prints the **Process Name (N)** and **Process ID (P)** right alongside the network packet, showing you exactly which app (e.g., *Google Chrome*, *Spotify*, *Slack*) sent or received the data. Stack Exchange +1

Alternative Varieties

Depending on your exact goal, you can modify the command:

1. Save All Traffic to a File (For Wireshark)

If you want to record the traffic to inspect it later visually via [Wireshark](#):

bash

```
sudo tcpdump -i pktap,all -s 0 -w ~/Desktop/all_traffic.pcapng
```

Use code with caution.

(Press **Ctrl + C** when you are done capturing to save the file). [the agile admin](#) +1

2. Monitor Traffic on a Single Interface

If "all" interfaces is providing too much noise, check your active interface names first:

bash

```
networksetup -listallhardwareports
```

Use code with caution.

If your Wi-Fi card is `en0`, you can isolate it like this: [the agile admin](#)

bash

```
sudo tcpdump -i en0 -nn
```

Use code with caution.

3. Capture Everything Except One Port

If you are connected via SSH and want to monitor all traffic *except* your own SSH session (to prevent a feedback loop of text lagging your terminal), add a port filter:

bash

```
sudo tcpdump -i pktap,all -nn port not 22
```

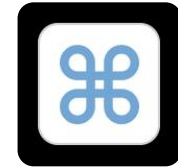
Use code with caution.

Would you like to narrow down this capture to a **specific IP address** or **port**, or are you trying to troubleshoot a **particular app** that is using your data?

 8 sites

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Dec 23, 2021 — 1 Answer. Sorted by: 3. You can use the PKTAP pseudo-interface which provide packet-metadata such as the effective process id and ...



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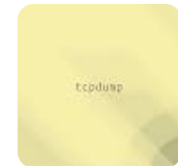
May 26, 2017 — To use tcpdump on OSX, you can: 1. Figure out which network interface you want to dump. You can use the command `networksetup -lis...



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Tcpdump Command in Linux

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Tcpdump

<https://www.tcpdump.org/manpages/tcpdump.1.html>

tcpdump(1) man page | TCPDUMP & LIBPCAP

Apr 24, 2026 — **tcpdump** prints out a description of the contents of packets on a network interface that match the Boolean expression (see pcap-filter(7) for the expression ...



Stack Overflow

1 answer · 12 years ago

tcpdump monitor mode on OS X does not show other ...

I'm using a macbook air with osx 10.8.4 and i want to sniff the packets in with same Wi-Fi network. I installed the tcpdump and i can get my own machine's ...

[1 answer](#) · Top answer: If you capture in monitor mode on a protected (WEP or WPA/WPA2) network: fi...

[How to display all data using tcpdump? \[closed ...](#) 2 answers Jul 13, 2016

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the agile admin

<https://theagileadmin.com/2017/05/26/tcpdump-and-...>

Tcpdump and Wireshark on OSX

May 26, 2017 — Tcpdump and Wireshark on OSX · networksetup -listallhardwareports. Then, run a packet trace on that interface. · **sudo tcpdump -i en0 -s 0 -B ...**



nixCraft

 <https://www.cyberciti.biz> › [faq](#) › [tcpdump-capture-reco...](#)

TCPDump: Capture and Record Specific Protocols / Port ...

Dec 16, 2025 — Explains how to monitor, record, capture and view TCP/UDP/ICMP ports traffic using the **tcpdump command** on UNIX, Linux, macOS (OS X) and ...



Stack Exchange

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[1 answer](#) · Top answer: You can use the PKTAP pseudo-interface which provide packet-metadata such...



SS64 Command line reference

<https://ss64.com> › [mac](#) › [tcpdump](#)

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[7 answers](#) · Top answer: [r/lostredditors](#) But not all wireless ...



Server Fault

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Log network traffic with process ID on Mac OS X?

Nov 29, 2010 — I want to log all network traffic on a Mac OS X server (like tcpdump does), but including the ID of the process that is responsible. Using lsof only ...

[4 answers](#) · Top answer: While the nettop is nice for viewing the snapshot of current connections, you c...

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